

Apex, NC 27539 | 301-461-6166 | trus.productguy@gmail.com

PRODUCT LEADER: 13+ years Ed-Tech product experience across Higher Ed and K-12, with specific experience in assessment, platform modernization, and pedagogy. Led product lines at scale (\$100 million+ yearly), as well 0→1 products. AI-first, GM type leader with blend of skills in Business, UX, Tech, and GTM.

EDUCATION: **MS: Human-Computer Interaction Design** | Indiana University, School of Informatics
BS: Business; Marketing Major | Indiana University, Kelley School of Business

CERTIFICATIONS: AI for Product Management by Pendo

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McGraw Hill

Apr. 2024 – Current

Sr. Product Manager – Digital Assessments

Hired to build new product team and operating model for assessment, managing 2 PMs for 4 engineering teams

- ◆ Defined acquisition, engagement, and retention KPIs to measure K-12 digital assessment product line and built analytics dashboards that became the standard across other product lines
- ◆ Led the launch of an internal AI tool that saved \$2.75 million in vendor content review costs through identifying errors in assessment content across math, science, and other curriculum areas
- ◆ Launched new assessment grading capabilities, addressing a source of churn affecting millions of dollars
- ◆ Restructured team organization to align to OKRs, improving impact, velocity, and delivery predictability
- ◆ Built a dedicated team to drive state-wide education sales through 3rd party assessment integrations, launching a bundled offering with Pearson Education
- ◆ Promoted AI-fluency and adoption across org, founding committee to drive adoption of an AI prototyping tool to improve customer discovery, and building an AI agent to help PMs with requirements writing

Cengage / WebAssign (Acquired by Cengage in 2016)

Nov. 2012 – Feb. 2024

Product Director (Apr. 2021 – Feb. 2024)

Led product for WebAssign, a learning and testing platform making \$100 million+ yearly from 1 million+ students

- ◆ Promoted to newly created role to own vision, strategy, and overall success for WebAssign, establishing new discovery and collaboration processes to enhance execution and deliver on customer needs
- ◆ Drove 10% two-year unit growth while surpassing forecasts, overseeing end-to-end product lifecycle from ideation to go-to-market for targeted enhancements most critical to customer retention
- ◆ Oversaw 40+ member cross functional team to drive the strategic consolidation of a \$15 million+ Chemistry course offering into a unified Math and Science platform to address sources of churn and reduce company costs and complexity of maintaining 2 separate, similar products
- ◆ Drove LMS integration improvements with Canvas, Blackboard, D2L, and other LMS' to drive CSAT improvements from improved onboarding and course experience for faculty and course coordinators
- ◆ Re-imagined Mastery Learning to drive market share in new customer segments, leading a cross-functional team through content development guidelines and GTM to launch of a successful new product offering
- ◆ Launched a Proof of Concept Generative AI math solution for students within 90 days that favorably impacted product adoption for >80% of math teachers
- ◆ Committee member and speaker at internal product development conference for ~1000 employees
- ◆ Nominated to mentor rising leaders on product management within internal company leadership program
- ◆ Mentored Associate Product Manager to strengthen execution skills who was promoted within 1 year

Product Manager (Nov. 2012 – Apr. 2021)

PM of 9 person cross-functional team for College Statistics courses spanning digital tools, content, and textbooks

- ◆ Achieved 21% product line growth over 3 years, significantly outperforming other company product lines
- ◆ Won Team of the Year Runner-Up (30 teams) for fostering strong collaboration and operational excellence
- ◆ Managed ~500k yearly budget, hiring authors and vendors for content and technology product launches
- ◆ Launched innovative data analysis tool >80% teachers agreed improved teaching and learning outcomes
- ◆ Launched, under budget, textbook that achieved 40% growth via addressing market feedback and trends
- ◆ Partnered with experts to produce video lessons, developing a storytelling framework later adopted by other product teams based on positive customer feedback
- ◆ Managed product assistants, delegating administrative tasks while coaching them through career growth

Core PM for WebAssign and 0 to 1 learning and testing products, driving the efforts of 3 Product Owners

- ◆ Drove consistent 10% YoY revenue growth for WebAssign by aligning product vision, strategy, and roadmap to balance business and customers needs with company goals to modernize the technical stack
- ◆ Pitched the business case and launched a 0 → 1 new assessment product line that placed over 150k students into math courses, opening up a new revenue stream in an adjacent market
- ◆ Led the creation of a 0 → 1 low-level math product designed to support struggling students, strategically integrating growth mindset content and gamification to build habits, motivation, and engagement
- ◆ Impacted new user retention and CSAT by partnering with Product Owners, Product Marketing, UX, and Engineering to launch usability wins, including a tool saving teachers 1000's of hours with course setup
- ◆ Launched Class Insights, an award winning analytics suite that enabled students to practice 1 million math and science problems to prepare for tests, within 3 months of post-launch
- ◆ Revamped team processes across customer discovery, engineering and sales collaboration, stakeholder communication, and go-to-market to drive greater customer-centricity and business impact
- ◆ Provided thought leadership via webinars, articles, and more to maximize GTM impact of product releases
- ◆ Mentored Associate Product Manager, contributing to their promotion within 2 years

Lulu

Mar. 2011 – Nov. 2012

Product Manager of User Experience

Dual PM and UX Lead for a 100-person book publishing and eCommerce site generating \$35 million annually

- ◆ Led cross-functional 10+ member engineering team to overhaul core publishing product from scratch to rectify tech scalability, address customer needs, and improve operational efficiency
- ◆ Redesigned funnel for eCommerce engine re-write to improve shopping cart conversions
- ◆ Reduced clicks to open customer support cases by 35% through launching a redesigned self-help portal

Pearson Education

Sep. 2008 - Mar. 2011

Interaction Designer

UX Designer within Higher-Ed for a market-leading education product used by 5 million+ active teachers

- ◆ Balanced requirements, usability data, metrics, and tech feasibility on an agile team to create low and high fidelity prototypes to improve the mobile and desktop user experience of complex customer workflows
- ◆ Executed competitive analyses on learning management systems to uncover new potential features
- ◆ Guided user research efforts to improve UX including usability studies, competitive analysis, and personas

See more, including launching a gaming website with 5,000+ users at 15 years old - [linkedin.com/in/andy-trus](https://www.linkedin.com/in/andy-trus)